

"We have successfully increased Uttar Pradesh's agricultural growth rate from 8 percent to 18 percent. The state's greatest potential lies in agriculture and allied sectors."

Yogi Adityanath
Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh

Improved Irrigation

The most defining dimension of this transformation lies in irrigation. Through canal rejuvenation, new projects, and modernised tubewells, irrigation capacity has expanded significantly. Today, approximately 105 lakh hectares (47 lakh in the Kharif season and 58 lakh in Rabi) are under irrigation, the highest in the country. Completion of 1,309 irrigation projects has created an additional 52.13 lakh hectares of irrigation potential, benefiting over 241 lakh farmers. With 76,527 kilometres of canals, 71 dams, and over 36,000 government tubewells operational, the state's water infrastructure has been substantially strengthened. Flood control efforts have also been scaled up, with 1,950 projects safeguarding 34.2 lakh hectares of land and providing relief to millions. Upcoming projects such as the Mid-Ganga Stage-II, Kanhar, and the Ken–Betwa link are poised to further fortify irrigation capacity in the years ahead.

Sugarcane and stability: powering the rural economy

Sugarcane continues to anchor the state's agrarian economy, and the sector has seen notable expansion. The area under cultivation has increased from 20.54 lakh hectares in 2016–17 to 28.61 lakh hectares in 2025–26, while productivity has improved from 72 to 83.25 tonnes per hectare. With 120 operational sugar mills and an enhanced crushing capacity of 8.48 lakh tonnes per day, the sector supports nearly one million jobs, directly and indirectly. Uttar Pradesh ranks first in both sugarcane and sugar production, contributing 57 percent of the country's total sugarcane output. The rise of ethanol production has added a new layer of stability. From 42 crore litres in 2017 to 187.80 crore litres in 2025–26, ethanol output has expanded significantly ensuring timely payments to farmers while creating additional revenue streams for mills.

Responsive governance: support during crisis

Recognising the vulnerability of agriculture to climatic disruptions, the government has adopted responsive measures during crises. Following unseasonal rains that affected wheat crops, procurement norms were relaxed allowing higher tolerance for lustre loss and broken grains. This ensured that farmers were not forced into distress sales at lower prices. At procurement centres, efforts were made to ensure basic amenities such as drinking water, fans, and shelter reflecting a focus not only on policy but also on the lived experience of farmers. Simultaneously, the promotion of the e-mandi system has enhanced transparency and efficiency. Over 1.71 lakh e-licences have been issued, and more than 6.42 crore online transaction slips generated reducing intermediaries and enabling farmers to secure better prices. Facilities such as canteens and rest houses named after Mata Shabari have further improved market accessibility and comfort.



Rising dairy sector

The dairy sector in Uttar Pradesh has emerged as a powerful pillar of rural prosperity, witnessing rapid and remarkable growth. Milk production has increased by nearly 40 percent from 277 lakh metric tonnes in 2016–17 to 388 lakh metric tonnes in 2024–25. Today, the state contributes around 16 percent to the country's total milk production, reflecting both scale and sustained progress. This growth signals a significant shift: farmers are no longer dependent solely on crop cultivation but are increasingly embracing dairy as a stable and supplementary source of income. Notably, one of the defining features of this agricultural transformation is the rising participation of women. Through self-help groups, lakhs of women are actively engaged in dairy, processing, and marketing activities. Initiatives such as providing free space to women in sugarcane committees have created new platforms for participation. Women are now running Prerna canteens and selling their products, thereby expanding their income streams and strengthening their financial independence. Women-led groups are collecting millions of litres of milk daily and have generated business worth thousands of crores adding fresh momentum to the rural economy. At the national level, Uttar Pradesh has also received recognition for its outstanding performance in agriculture. The state has been awarded the Krishi Karman Award along with incentive grants for achieving the highest production of foodgrains and oilseeds. This is not merely an award but a testament to the state's evolving agricultural identity.

Taken together, the transformation is clear: the farmer in Uttar Pradesh is no longer just a cultivator but is steadily evolving into an entrepreneur market-aware, technology-driven, and capable of generating diversified income. Under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, agricultural policies have steered farming towards a future that balances productivity with profitability, and growth with stability. As a result, the farmer in Uttar Pradesh today appears more self-reliant, resilient, and resourceful than ever before.